

HumpLump

6 OR 7 SKITS

"Six, maybe seven, clown-fed collisions with the absurdity of the modern world."

MISSION STATEMENT

Hump Lump creates bold, playful and politically aware theatre that confronts the absurdity of contemporary politics, society and pop culture. Through clowning, satire, rough theatre and direct audience engagement, we aim to break through modern numbness and invite audiences to laugh, question and think again.

▶ WATCH PROOF OF CONCEPT

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PROJECT SYNOPSIS

6 or 7 Skits is a political and social satire created by Hump Lump, a devised theatre company exploring how world events can be reimagined through clowning, rough theatre and absurd performance. The piece is structured as a non-linear sketch show made up of six, maybe seven, short skits. Each skit responds to a real-life political, social or pop-cultural event, using satire to expose the ridiculousness, contradictions and discomfort already present in the world around us.

The performance is framed as a "play within a play," where literal clowns enter a theatrical playground to act out real-world figures, public narratives and media events. Rather than presenting these stories through realism, Hump Lump uses exaggeration, disruption and play to make familiar events feel strange again. This allows the audience to encounter subjects they may already feel desensitised to, but from a new and uncomfortable angle.



The Cheer

MARKETING BLURB

Feeling numb to the chaos of the world? *6 or 7 Skits* throws politics, pop culture and modern masculinity into a clown-filled playground of satire. Through verbatim, puppetry, absurdism, music and audience interaction, Hump Lump turns real events into ridiculous, uncomfortable and strangely recognisable theatre.



The Alpha Podcast

STYLE & THEMES

The company's style combines clowning, rough theatre, verbatim material, puppetry, absurdism, repetition and musicality. Traditional clown archetypes such as the Whiteface, Auguste and Hobo/Tramp inform the company's character work, while rough theatre shapes the live, exposed and deliberately imperfect quality of the performance. Costume changes happen in view, the fourth wall is broken, and the audience are treated as active witnesses rather than passive observers.

Thematically, the work is connected through masculinity. As four male performers, the company uses satire to question the performance of male power, authority, ego, control and fragility across political and cultural spaces. The piece does not aim to provide neat answers. Instead, it creates a space where laughter becomes a way into discomfort, and where the absurdity of real events can be made visible again.

Ultimately, *6 or 7 Skits* aims to break through numbness. In a world where contradiction, spectacle and irresponsibility can quickly become normalised, Hump Lump uses clowning and satire to remind audiences that the outrageous should still feel outrageous.

Key Technical Information

SHOW DURATION

45 Minutes

SET UP / STRIKE

20 Minutes Each

COMPANY SIZE

4 Performers

HOST FEES

Please Contact:
clowns@humplump.com

SPACE REQUIRED

8m x 8m x 4m
(Clear, flat surface)

PARKING REQUIRED

Space for 1 touring van

ACCESS NEEDS

None

TECH REQUIREMENTS

Fully Self-Sufficient. No mics, house lights, modular set.

Performance Risk Assessment

RISK ASSESSMENT KEY

HIGH (RS 11-25)

MEDIUM (RS 6-10)

LOW (RS 1-5)

Risk Score (RS) = Likelihood (L) x Severity (S)

HAZARD / ACTIVITY	PERSONS AT RISK & HARM	PRE-CONTR OL RISK SCORE (RS)	CONTROL MEASURES	TARGE T RISK SCORE
R1: THE LIFT Ishaan lifting Calvin aggressively prior to the injection sequence.	Ishaan & Calvin Strains, hernia, head bumps, fractures if dropped.	L: 3 S: 4 RS: 12 (HIGH)	- Walked through and rehearsed at half-speed before every performance. - Ishaan uses proper lifting form (bend at knees, keep back straight, lift with legs). - Calvin maintains tight core tension to assist lift and prevent dead-weighting. - Both actors wear barefoot footwear improved traction/balance.	L: 1 S: 3 RS: 3 (LOW)
R2: SLIP HAZARD Use of cereal to represent raw meat crushed/dropped during Sigma skit.	Cast Slipping leading to pulled muscles, bruising, or sprains during high-speed movement.	L: 4 S: 2 RS: 8 (MED)	- Limit cereal amount used to bare minimum. - Crushed downstage area away from paths. - Immediate sweep/clear debris during transitions/strike.	L: 2 S: 2 RS: 4 (LOW)

HAZARD / ACTIVITY	PERSONS AT RISK & HARM	PRE- CONTR OL RISK SCORE (RS)	CONTROL MEASURES	TARGE T RISK SCORE
R3: CHANGES Tripping over clothing, racks, or crates in 5x5m playground.	Cast Tripping resulting in blisters, abrasions, bruising, or sprained ankles.	L: 3 S: 3 RS: 9 (MED)	- Designated rehearsed safe zones for discarded costumes. - Clothing racks must have wheels locked. - Prop crates clearly labeled and placed securely at perimeter.	L: 2 S: 2 RS: 4 (LOW)
R4: PHYSICAL COMEDY Drops and collisions during Trump glitch / interruptions.	Cast Head bumps, joint injuries, or heavy bruising.	L: 3 S: 3 RS: 9 (MED)	- Strictly block all falls to ensure safe landing techniques (absorbing impact). - Establish clear spatial awareness and eye-contact cues. - Falls kept slow during rehearsal to prepare for slips.	L: 1 S: 3 RS: 3 (LOW)
R5: MANUAL HANDLING Moving heavy boxes during rapid set-up and strike.	Cast Pulled muscles, strained back muscles, hernia, or dropped items on toes.	L: 3 S: 2 RS: 6 (MED)	- All actors utilise safe lifting techniques. - Heavy crates/blocks team-lifted if necessary.	L: 1 S: 2 RS: 2 (LOW)